Syllabus

MBA703 Mastering Excel Essentials to Enhance Business Value

Instructor

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Course Description

If you are interested in working in dynamic environments that place a strong emphasis on data-driven, quantitative analysis, this course is designed for you. Whether you are an experienced professional seeking to enhance your skills or someone looking to pivot into a cutting-edge industry, this course provides valuable insights and knowledge to help you thrive in today's data-centric and rapidly evolving landscape.

This course is part of the Performance Based Admission courses for the MBA program.

“Mastering Excel Essentials to Enhance Business Value” focuses on knowledge that is essential for corporate professionals. The course focuses on practical, real-world examples and provides step-by-step tutorials, quizzes, and practice exercises to build a strong knowledge base. By the end of the course, students will be equipped with essential Excel skills that can be applied to solve a wide variety of business problems.

The course’s specific toolbox is fundamental for the following reasons. Spreadsheets are ubiquitous in today’s business environment. A corporate professional should be fluent in their use. Deploying Excel’s functionality to support model creation and analysis also enhances and reinforces students’ analytical skills and their ability to use information intelligently. In other words, the course’s toolbox will allow you to use Excel as a problem-solving tool, and also help you present your findings in a compelling and organized manner.

You will learn how to design and create workbooks and worksheets for professional purposes that incorporate the following principles of spreadsheet engineering:

- Suitability for efficient analysis
- Readability (can be understood by a non-author)
- Transferability (to another analyst or user)
- Accuracy (computes the mathematical model without error)
- Reusability (can easily be employed again with different data)
- Modifiability (can be extended or adapted to new circumstances)

The toolbox for this course includes lessons tied to understanding the basic core of Excel, data inputting, cleaning, formatting and manipulating, as well as navigating large data sets. We will also cover the use of essential Excel formulas and functions needed for professional success. More specifically, the course starts with an overview of Excel’s user interface, followed by how to create and manage spreadsheets that are error-free and easy to navigate. The course also covers important Excel functions that allow users to automate their analysis and to create compelling reports, including learning how to visualize your data using Excel’s graphing functionality.

Software Requirements

Microsoft Excel

Course Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, you will be able to:

- Design and create workbooks and worksheets for coursework and professional purposes.
- Effectively input data and efficiently navigate large spreadsheets.
- Employ various “hacks” and expertly apply (the most appropriate) built-in functions in Excel to increase productivity and streamline workflow.
- Organize, cleanse, manage and analyze vast datasets proficiently.
- Generate engaging and informative Excel reports by leveraging best practices in spreadsheet design along with Excel’s charting functionality.

Course Materials

The link to reading materials and resources to learn on the topics can be found in each week’s learning module. All materials are available online for free, no required resources need to be purchased. There is no required textbook to supplement the course materials. Note: Be aware that some resources may open in a new tab.

Course Outline

The course consists of 3 modules that focus on the following key areas:

Module 1: Excel Foundations

Key concepts

Lesson 1: Excel Interface & Basics

Lesson 2: Excel Toolbox Development: Time Saving Features

Lesson 3: Excel Toolbox Development: Formulas and Functions

Readings

- Keyboard Terminology and Shortcuts – Module 1

Module 2: Essential Excel Tools for Professional Success

Key concepts

Lesson 1: Must-know Modeling Functions in Excel

Lesson 2: Dynamic Data Retrieval and Conditional Aggregation

Lesson 3: What’s New in Excel 365: Functions and Features

Readings

- Content Notes – Module 2

Module 3: Present Information and Create Value-Add in Excel.

Key concepts

Lesson 1: Designing Effective Spreadsheets that Work for You

Lesson 2: Communicating Insights with Excel Charts

Readings

- Content Notes – Module 3

Course Structure and Learning Activities

There are 3 content modules in this course and each module may take about 15-20 hours to complete. You can advance at your own pace; a consistent pace will help you complete the module and move on to the next course in the sequence. The final module consists of your final exam for the course.

This course is comprised of the following elements:

Learning Activities:

- **Readings**: Each module may include several required and/or supplemental readings. The supplementary materials are provided for you to help you to further explore the course topics.
- **Video Lessons**: In each module, the concepts you need to know will be presented through a collection of short videos. You may stream these videos for playback within the browser by clicking on their titles. You will be provided a workbook that corresponds to the video lessons for you to practice as you follow along.
- **Discussion Forum**: This course has a place for you to interact with other learners about class-related topics. Unless specified, discussion forums do not carry a score.
- **Practice Activities**: Each module will include some practice activities, intended for you to apply the knowledge presented in the video lessons to demonstrate your understanding of the topics. You will be provided with a spreadsheet to utilize while completing the activities. Upon submission, you will be provided with solutions in order to gauge your successful completion of the activities. These activities do not contribute toward your final score in the class.
- **Practice Quizzes**: Each module will include some practice quizzes, intended for you to assess your understanding of the topics. You will be allowed unlimited attempts at each practice quiz. There is no time limit on how long you take to complete each attempt at the quiz. These quizzes do not contribute toward your final score in the class.

Assessments:

- **Summative Module Assessments:** Each module will include at least one summative module

assessment. You need to receive an 80% to pass each assessment and you are allowed one attempt every eight hours for each assessment. There is no time limit on how long you take to complete each attempt at the assessment. Your highest grade will be recorded

- **Final Assessment:** This course will contain one final summative course assessment. You will be allowed one attempt for this assessment, and you must receive an 80% on the final exam to pass the course. Before taking the exam, please make sure you are in a place with reliable internet connection. No retakes will be granted for the lack of internet access. You are in an online program and the use of the Internet is a requirement.

How to Pass This Course

To qualify for a Course Certificate, simply start verifying your coursework at the beginning of the course and pay the fee. Coursera Financial Aid is available to offset the registration cost for learners with demonstrated economic needs. If you have questions about Course Certificates, please see the help topics here.

Also note that this course is part of Master of Business Administration program offered by Illinois Institute of Technology. By earning a Course Certificate in this course, you are on your way toward earning a Specialization Certificate in this topic. See more information about the program here.

If you choose not to pay the fee, you can still audit the course. You will still be able to view all videos, submit practice quizzes, and view required assessments. Auditing does not include the option to submit required assessments. As such, you will not be able to earn a grade or a Course Certificate.

The following table explains the breakdown for what is required in order to pass the class and qualify for a Course Certificate. You must pass each and every required activity in order to pass this course.

Activity	Required?	Number per Course	Estimated Time per Module	% Required to Pass	% of Total Grade
Lecture Videos	Yes	3-6 per module	.5-1 hour	N/A	N/A
Practice Quizzes	No	4-7 per module	.5 hour	N/A	N/A
Discussions	No	2 per course	1 hour	N/A	N/A
Summative Module Assessments	Yes	1 per module	.5 hour	80%	20% /each module (60%)
Final Formative Assessment	Yes	1 per course	1-3 hours	80%	40%

Getting and Giving Help

- Use the Learner Help Center to find information regarding specific technical problems. For example, technical problems would include error messages, difficulty submitting assignments, or problems with

video playback. If you cannot find an answer in the documentation, you can also report your problem to the Coursera staff by clicking on the *Contact Us!* link available on each topic's page within the Learner Help Center.
- Use the flag icon under each item to report errors in lecture video content, assignment questions and answers, assignment grading, text and links on course pages, or the content of other course materials.
- Familiarize yourself with Coursera's policy on Accessibility.

Academic Integrity

Your attentiveness to academic integrity reflects the value you place on your own work and the work of others. In addition to Coursera's Honor Code, we also have high expectations for conduct during course participation.

Discussion Forums: Expectations

Sharing an online course with other avid learners like you gives you a unique opportunity to share, collaborate, and learn from others and their experiences, and helps you reinforce your understanding of the topics of the course. Interacting in the Discussion Forums is a great way to engage with your online community. We know that it is not possible to read every discussion forum post, so we recommend that you read those that interest you; and reply when you can contribute. The forum is part of your class activities and everybody is expected to act professionally and be civil and respectful of others in your class. Failure to meet these expectations may be considered a break in the Academic Code of Conduct and may result in your removal from the course. Please, check tips and helpful tools to interact in discussion forums in this document.

Academic Code of Conduct

Above all else, learners are expected to ensure that their conduct helps to create an atmosphere conducive to learning and the interchange of knowledge. While it is understood that some of these items are subject to interpretation, learners should nonetheless endeavor to:

- Be respectful of fellow learners.
- Not discriminate against fellow learners in any manner.
- Conduct peer reviews in a timely manner and give useful feedback on what was done well, helpful suggestions for how to improve, and specific comments about why you gave the grade you chose to assist peers in their learning.
- Turn assignments in on time and follow instructions on all assignments including those affecting the use of technology.
- Be truthful in all communication, which includes, but is not limited to, avoiding academic dishonesty.

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